



HAWAII

Travel Diary

Paste
your doll's
picture
here



HAWAII-DAY 1

10:25 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Aloha from the beautiful Hawaiian Islands! I am standing in the gardens of Honolulu International Airport on the island of Oahu. It's amazing, you would think you were in a park somewhere—well, except for all the airplanes flying by! : ^) I like this airport, it has lots of open spaces instead of windows, and the warm breezes just blow through. The air is different here—tropical and sort of flowery. Must run to pick up Coconut and my suitcase now...more later!

12:10 p.m.

Dear Diary,

We're going to Waikiki beach! It's probably one of the most famous tourist beaches and there are a gazillion postcards of it, showing Diamond Head (that's the crater of this big extinct volcano) in the background. The man at our hotel said that it used to be called *Laeahi* by the Hawaiians, which means "brow of the tuna" (as in *fish*). But when British sailors saw how it sparkled in the sun, they thought it must be full of diamonds, so they changed its name. Too bad they found out that there were NO diamonds there, only crystals! I wonder how come the name stayed, even though it was wrong?

3:45 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Wow! Waikiki was fun! It was kind of crowded, with lots of people swimming and sunbathing and lots of surfers in the water. But I got to go for a ride in a real Hawaiian outrigger canoe. There were six people and we all got paddles and had to climb in and paddle out past the waves. Then we waited until a really good wave came and rode



it all the way down the beach! I've heard of surfing with surfboards and boogie boards and inner tubes—but I've never surfed in a canoe before! We caught three really big waves. I was *hau`oli* (happy)!

Day 2

6:40 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Yesterday evening we went to the Polynesian Cultural Center for a real *luau* (that's a Hawaiian feast). I was given a *lei*, a necklace of beautiful flowers, as a welcome when we arrived. Then we spent some time watching women making baskets from palm leaves and a man starting a fire

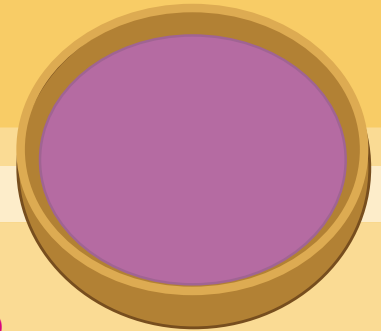
with sticks. There was dancing and canoe rides (which I didn't take) and lots of people singing. Hawaiians love to sing in a group, I guess, and it's a beautiful sound with so many voices, even though I didn't understand the words. At the luau they roasted a whole pig in the ground—I know it sounds a little gross, but there wasn't any dirt on it when they served it, and it was delicious! We also ate sweet potatoes and chicken long rice and fish and fruit—oh, and poi, which is made from pounded taro root. It's kind of white and gluey and you dip your hand into a bowl and lick it off your fingers. It was a little different, but at least I can say I tried it!

5:30 p.m.

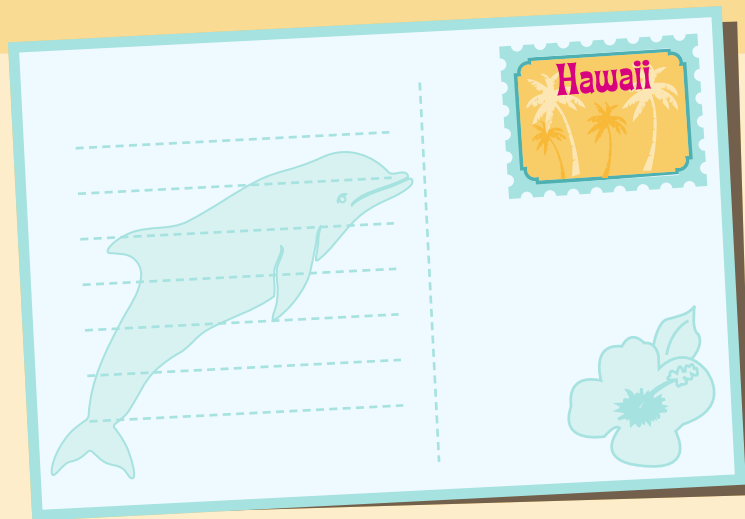
Dear Diary,

I got to swim with dolphins! We went to Sea Life Park and had a Dolphin Adventure, and no matter what I do next, that will always be the best thing about Hawaii for me! First I went snorkeling and watched the dolphins swim by underwater. Then I got to feed one some fish, and grab its fin and get a belly ride—and THEN I got to have my picture taken while a dolphin gave me a KISS! We all got splashed plenty of times, and I got water up my nose, but I didn't care.

Afterward we looked at the



underwater reefs and saw turtles and penguins and sea lions and the bird sanctuary. Later we went to the dolphin show. Diary, I am sooo happy!



Here's the postcard I'm sending to a friend back home.

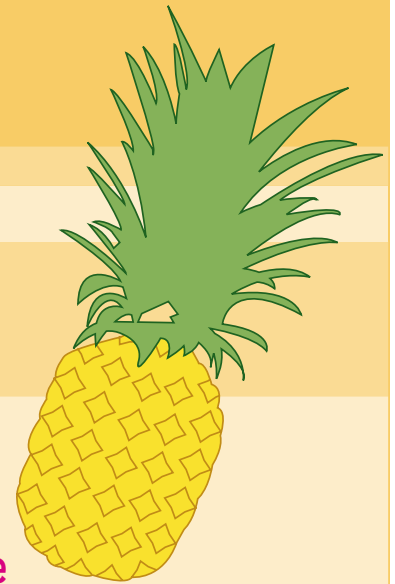
[Write a message on the back of the card.]

Day 3

3:25 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Today we went to the Dole Pineapple Plantation. The Pineapple Garden Maze was my favorite part. You got a card with a time stamped on it and you had to run around looking for all these boxes so you could stencil stuff on the card- and you had to try to do it in the shortest amount of time. There are 1.7 miles of paths in the maze, which is made out of 11,400 plants (most of them hibiscus). You could hear little kids yelling when they found



something, and if you followed their voices, you could find it, too! I took us forty minutes, which isn't anywhere near the record of *five minutes!*

8:40 p.m.
Dear Diary,

Just a quick good night, dear diary. The moon is shining through my window, and I can hear the sound of the waves breaking nearby. We leave for the big island of Hawaii in the morning!

Day 4

10:10 a.m.
Dear Diary,

We're on a bus tour heading for Hawaii Volcanoes National Park. The tour is going to take all day, so I will catch up later, diary. Writing on the bus makes me a little sick.

4:30 p.m.
Dear Diary,

The park was the most amazing thing I've ever seen. We started at the Kilauea Visitor Center and saw a film about volcanoes. Then we walked around the rim of Kilauea Crater, which mostly looks like dark mud

with steamy gases coming out of the middle. We also went to the end of Chain of Craters Road, where you could see real lava flowing into the ocean! You had to use binoculars because it's way too dangerous to get close to the lava. We walked across black lava fields that are all cooled off, except it was so sunny and hot that you felt like the ground was still burning. We had to carry water to drink—and then it rained! The lava is 50% *silica*—that's glass—so if you fell on it, you could really skin your hands and knees. But I didn't, luckily.

6:00 p.m.
Dear Diary,

Tonight we're staying near the park in a cottage in Pahala. Pahala used to be a big sugar plantation, but these days it grows coffee and macadamia nuts. Our place has a swing hanging from a banyan tree and coconut palms. Not too far away is a swimming pool. It's been a busy day, diary, so good night for now.

Day 5

9:43 a.m.
Dear Diary,

It may seem early, but I've already been to the beach at Punalu'u! And guess what? It's got black sand! That's because it's volcanic sand. Did you know that you use sand to make



to make glass? Yep! You heat it up really hot and it melts into glass! Even more interesting is that beach at Punalu'u is a turtle beach—that means the sea turtles come here to lay their eggs in the sand. I was really hoping to see that, but it's not the right time of year. I did see some green sea turtles swimming in the water! They're protected and you're not allowed to touch them or swim toward them.

11:00 a.m.
Dear Diary,

We went shopping and I got a puka shell necklace and a real Hawaiian shirt. It's red and has hibiscus flowers all over it. Some of the shirts

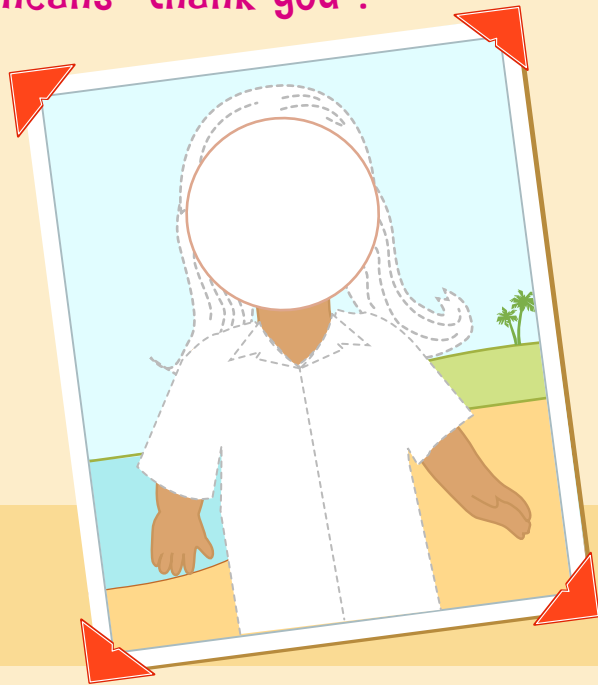
had surfers or palm trees or other kinds of flowers printed on them. Some even had whales and turtles! But I like my shirt just the way it is.

3:22 p.m.
Dear Diary,

We're back on the bus and heading for the Kohala Coast. After lunch we stopped at a *tiki* carver's studio. Tikis are statues (usually carved out of wood) of ancient Hawaiian gods. They have scary expressions on their faces because they're supposed to chase away evil spirits. The four main gods from Hawaiian mythology are: Ku, the god of war; Lono,



the god of fertility and peace; Kane, the god of light and life; and Kanaloa, the god of the sea. I didn't get a tiki, but I did get a painted *ukelele* (like a tiny guitar) charm on a cord to wear around my neck. And I said "*Mahalo!*" when I left—that means "thank you"!



Design your own Hawaiian shirt!

[Print and paste photos of your doll's head to complete the picture.]

DAY 6

10:30 a.m.

Dear Diary,

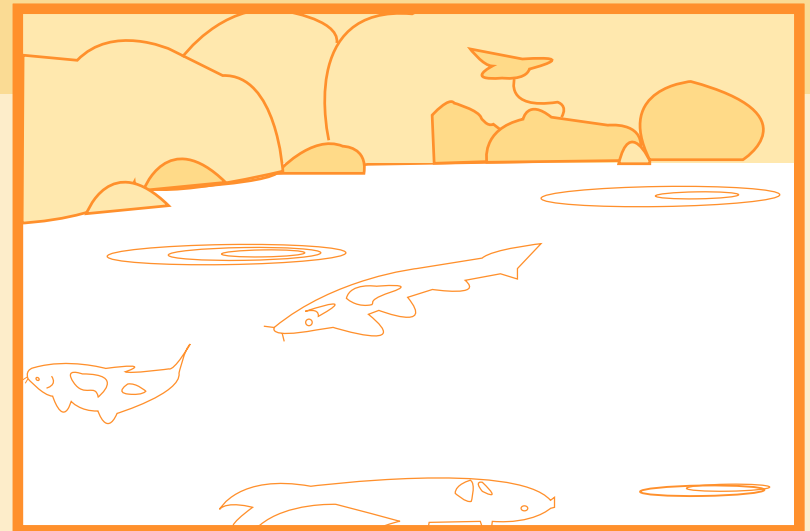
We just explored Mo'okini Heiau, an ancient temple. It's about as big as a football field and is made of thousands of stones. Hawaiian folklore says that each stone was passed, hand to hand, from the Polulu Valley 14 miles away—and that the temple was finished in just one night! It's about 1,500 years old. Near the temple is the birthplace of Kamehameha the Great, who was one of Hawaii's most famous kings. The day he was born, Halley's comet was crossing the sky like a fireball, so right away his people believed he would be special. And he was!

We're just about to leave for Oahu and our last night in the Hawaiian islands.

Hawaii—only this time it will mean “good bye” instead of “hello”! And then...where next, dear diary?.

5:20 p.m.
Dear Diary

The days have gone so fast! I can't believe how much I've seen and done in such a short time. But there are things about this trip I will never forget. The last thing we did today was visit the Byodo-In Temple, a copy of a 900-year-old Buddhist temple in Uji, Japan. It was a very peaceful place, with gray tiled roofs and koi ponds and a nine-foot-high golden Buddha. Now it's bedtime. In the morning we leave for the airport and it's Aloha again to



Colorful koi!

[Decorate and color your own fish pond.]